



WE DIDN'T GET TOO MANY OPPORTUNITIES IN THE TEST FORMAT WHEN WE WERE PLAYING CRICKET, BUT HOPEFULLY, THE NEW GENERATION WILL GET MANY MORE GAMES – HARMANPREET KAUR

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“We didn't get too many opportunities in the Test format when we were playing cricket, but hopefully, the new generation will get many more games. We have a busy schedule in the T20Is and ODIs, but Tests are actually a format that teaches you patience and gives a chance to improve your skills,” India captain Harmanpreet Kaur said after her first game as Test skipper.

Acing the test: England was bowled out in the first session of day three to fall to a crushing 347-run defeat in the one-off Test against India.

EMMANUAL YOGINI

She led the team to a thumping 347-run win over archrival England in the one-off Test in Navi Mumbai this month.

Where has one heard this call for more Tests before?

Oh yes, after the remarkable draw against England in Bristol and the same result against Australia in the Pink Ball Test in Carrara, both in

2021. Op-eds, interview quotes, and analysis pieces of a similar vein came around once more after England drew South Africa in a lone Test in 2022. The conversation for more Test cricket in the women's game sometimes feels like a disc running in a broken record player, gratingly stuck in the same spot.

A big-three exclusive?

How practical is a call for more red-ball cricket in the women's international ecosystem?

“If you look at the larger picture, it's only Australia, England, and India playing because these are the boards with the resources to do so. Having said that, none of us have domestic cricket for the longest version of the game. To expect Test cricket to grow, it needs to return at the domestic level,” former India captain Shubhangi Kulkarni points out.

“Australia and England play for historical reasons. India has always wanted to play Test cricket, and despite getting few games, it usually does well at it. From sponsorship to spectators and TV coverage, I don't know if there's as much of an appetite for Test cricket as compared to the shorter formats. But it can always be built, and a way to do that is by getting it back at the domestic level,” the seasoned administrator adds.

After struggling to acclimatise adequately to the pressures of Test cricket in the unforgiving heat and humidity of Navi Mumbai, England skipper Heather Knight said this: